

Provision of Supports Policy

VERSION 1.0	EFFECTIVE	NEXT REVIEW	OWNER Principal / Key Management Personnel	APPROVED BY Governing body
-----------------------	-----------	-------------	--	--------------------------------------

PURPOSE AT A GLANCE

This policy covers the whole participant journey: how people access []'s supports, how service agreements and support plans are developed with each participant, how support is delivered responsively and safely, how continuity is maintained, and how planned transitions to and from [] are managed.

1. Purpose and scope

This policy supports [] to apply the Access to Supports, Service Agreements, Support Planning, Responsive Support Provision and Transitions NDIS Practice Standards. It applies to all services and supports delivered by [] and to all employees, contractors and volunteers (**Workers**), who must take full responsibility for understanding and following it. It should be read alongside the related documents in the final section and the corresponding procedures in the Policy Register.

2. Policy aims

[] is committed to ensuring that:

- each participant accesses the most appropriate support for their needs, goals and preferences, and is actively involved in developing and regularly reviewing their support plan;
- each participant clearly understands the support they have chosen and how it will be provided, and accesses responsive, timely, competent and appropriate support in a safe environment; and
- each participant experiences a planned and coordinated transition to or from [].

3. Access to supports

To be considered for support, a person must be a person with disability of an age [] is registered to support, live within []'s service area, be seeking a support [] provides, and have NDIS or private funding.

[] gives each potential participant clear information (Support Information) about the supports offered, their price, any access, entry and eligibility criteria, and the circumstances in which support can be withdrawn — in the language, mode of communication and terms they are most likely to understand, with bilingual staff or interpreters arranged as needed.

Each request is assessed against the access and entry criteria and []'s capacity and resources, through an open and accountable process, applying non-discriminatory eligibility criteria. [] reviews the proposed support delivery environment with the participant and their support network and makes and monitors reasonable adjustments so it is fit for purpose and supports the participant's health, privacy, dignity, quality of life and independence.

4. Service agreements

[] collaborates with each participant to develop a written Services Agreement that establishes expectations, explains the supports to be delivered and specifies any conditions and why they apply. The appropriate template is used as the starting point — the general Services Agreement, the Support Coordination Services Agreement, or the Services Agreement (SIL) — together with the Services Schedule.

Participants are supported to understand their agreement, with interpreters or advocates arranged on request. [] uses its best endeavours to put every agreement in writing and give the participant a signed copy; if that is not practicable, or the participant chooses not to have a copy, the circumstances and material terms are recorded on the participant's file. The Privacy Consent Form forms part of the agreement.

For SIL supports in specialist disability accommodation, [] enters into an SDA and SIL Collaboration Agreement with the SDA provider and the participant, covering responsibilities and roles, how concerns and conflicts are handled, how changes are agreed and communicated, how vacancies are filled in shared living, and how behaviours of concern that put a tenancy at risk are managed. Agreements set out the arrangements for support in an emergency or disaster.

5. Support planning

With the participant's consent, [] works with the participant and their support network to assess needs and develop a support plan that reflects the participant's needs, requirements, preferences, strengths and goals. Risk assessments are undertaken and documented in the plan — including the degree to which the participant relies on []'s services and the effect a disruption would have on their health and safety — and strategies to treat known risks are planned and implemented, with periodic reviews of their effectiveness.

Each support plan is reviewed at least annually, or earlier as the participant's needs or circumstances change; progress toward goals is assessed and the plan updated where progress differs from what was expected. The plan is provided in the participant's preferred language and mode of communication, is readily accessible to the participant and to workers, anticipates responses to emergencies and disasters, and — with the participant's consent — is shared with their support network, other providers and relevant government agencies.

6. Responsive support provision

Support is based on the least intrusive options, consistent with contemporary, evidence-informed practice that meets the participant's needs and helps achieve their goals. With the participant's consent, [] develops and maintains links with other providers (including health and allied health) to share information, manage risks and meet needs. Reasonable efforts are made to involve the participant in selecting their workers, including the preferred gender of workers providing personal care. Where a participant has specific needs requiring monitoring or daily support, workers are appropriately trained and understand those needs and preferences.

7. Sole support and significant risk factors

For a participant receiving Personal Support who is Subject to a Significant Risk Factor, [] does not allow personal support to be provided by a sole worker unless it has assessed the participant against the significant-risk-factor criteria and has a written service agreement in place, and it applies additional

monitoring, supervision and review, including a supervisor or independent person visiting the participant's home as far as practicable.

8. Continuity of supports

All reasonable efforts are made to ensure the same worker or group of workers provides support without interruption throughout the service agreement. Where changes or interruptions are unavoidable, alternative arrangements are explained and agreed with the participant and delivered in a way appropriate to their needs, preferences and goals, in line with the Business Continuity and Disaster Management Plan.

9. Safe environment

Each participant can easily identify workers who support them — all workers wear a photo identification card. [] works with the participant and, where relevant, other providers to ensure a safe support delivery environment and to correctly interpret the participant's needs and preferences. For participants needing communication support, clear arrangements help workers understand their communication and how they express emerging health concerns. Protocols for responding to medical emergencies are in place for each participant, workers are trained to respond (including distinguishing urgent from non-urgent situations), and escalation systems are established. Infection prevention and control standard precautions — hand hygiene, respiratory hygiene, cough etiquette and PPE — are implemented in all settings, with routine environmental cleaning outside participants' homes, and workers receive training and refresher training.

10. Transitions and withdrawal of supports

Planned transitions to or from [] are facilitated in collaboration with the participant and their support network, documented in an Exit and Transition Form, and effectively managed; risks associated with each transition — including temporary transitions such as hospitalisation — are identified, documented and responded to. Support may be withdrawn only where the participant ceases to meet the access criteria (age, service area, funding, or seeking a support [] provides), and never solely because of a dignity-of-risk choice; the participant is supported through a planned exit.

11. Definitions

[]
[], ABN [].

Client

A client of [], including an NDIS participant.

Key Management Personnel (KMP)

[], and other key management personnel involved in [] from time to time.

Principal

[].

Legislation Register

The register of legislation, regulations, rules and guidelines maintained by [].

Policy Register

The register of policies of [].

Worker

A permanent, fixed-term or casual member of staff, a contractor or a volunteer engaged by [redacted], including the Principal.

Plan

The written plan developed with and for the participant by the NDIA or its delegate.

Personal Support

The class of support referred to as assistance with daily personal activities under the NDIS.

Subject to a Significant Risk Factor

A participant who lives at home alone, is not receiving other face-to-face support services from any other provider, and for whom one or more of the following applies: limited or no regular face-to-face contact with people they are well acquainted with; limited or no physical mobility without another person's assistance, or reliance on equipment for mobility; or limited or no ability to communicate with others without assistance or equipment.

12. Related documents and approval

Related documents: Client Information Booklet · Services Agreement · Services Agreement (SIL) · Support Coordination Services Agreement · SDA and SIL Collaboration Agreement · Service Schedule · Privacy Consent Form · Client Support Plan · Client Emergency Plan · Risk Assessment Form · Risk Taking Form · Client Induction Checklist · Exit and Transition Form · Subject to a Significant Risk Factor Register · Business Continuity and Disaster Management Plan · Legislation Register · Policy Register.

Legislation and rules: as set out in the Legislation Register. If any part of this policy is inconsistent with applicable law, it is taken to be amended only to the extent needed to comply.

Approved by	[redacted]
Approval date	[redacted]
Next scheduled review	
Version	1.0